ReadPass Practice Test

英検準1級　リーディング問題

2026年度 第2回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____

解答方法　各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

ReadPassで復習

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(18)までの( )に入れるのに最も適切なものを1，2，3，4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(1) The cabin crew was forced to (1) a passenger on the airplane when he started to become violent toward a person sitting near him.

1 restrain　**2** recharge　**3** resume　**4** reflect

(2) Luna looked out of the window at the winter landscape, with its (2) trees and empty fields.

1 dizzy　**2** keen　**3** fussy　**4** bare

(3) Emir and Corinne were disappointed that they had to change their vacation (3), but it was necessary for them to take a different route because of the storm.

1 dignity　**2** controversy　**3** monarchy　**4** itinerary

(4) The couple took regular walks to (4) themselves with their new neighborhood. They wanted to learn their way around as quickly as possible.

1 confine　**2** inhibit　**3** familiarize　**4** seize

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q9

次の(1)から(18)までの( )に入れるのに最も適切なものを1，2，3，4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(5) ***A:*** Can we discuss that problem next week?
B: No, I'm sorry. It's a matter of great (5), so I need to have your answer today.

1 diversion　**2** maneuver　**3** urgency　**4** contempt

(6) The huge Christmas tree in the town square was a great sight in itself, but the colorful (6) that decorated it made it truly beautiful.

1 dwellings　**2** refuges　**3** prospects　**4** ornaments

(7) Peter spends most of his time at work doing (7) tasks, like typing letters, answering phones, and filing documents.

1 rugged　**2** clerical　**3** majestic　**4** apt

(8) The teacher warned the students not to (8) in front of the school after classes, as it made the school look bad.

1 loiter　**2** scratch　**3** mourn　**4** applaud

(9) The woman was so (9) with thoughts about her sick child that she did not notice when her husband arrived home.

1 preoccupied　**2** trespassed　**3** grated　**4** endorsed

大問1 語彙・文法 Q10-Q14

次の(1)から(18)までの( )に入れるのに最も適切なものを1，2，3，4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(10) The government official's (10) of the factory revealed that it was polluting the local river. The factory was soon ordered to stop.

1 column **2** succession **3** inaction **4** inspection

(11) The young politician was very (11). He believed he could solve every social problem, but most of the older politicians thought his ideas were impractical.

1 soothing **2** punctual **3** clumsy **4** idealistic

(12) The horse has a (12) habit of trying to chase its own tail. The owner has never seen any other horse do something so odd.

1 peculiar **2** conceited **3** fragrant **4** transparent

(13) The CEO of the company was a man of great (13) in society. His connections with famous politicians and celebrities were well-known.

1 distress **2** referral **3** detention **4** prominence

(14) The author provided an (14) of his new book on his website. He hoped that readers would enjoy the sample and buy the full version.

1 inheritance **2** excerpt **3** odor **4** agenda

大問1 語彙・文法 Q15-Q18

次の(1)から(18)までの( )に入れるのに最も適切なものを1，2，3，4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(15) After long discussions, the two sides were finally able to (15) a deal that was acceptable to both of them.

1 hammer out　**2** jump in　**3** weed out　**4** step aside

(16) Miranda plans to become a politician someday, so she is careful not to do anything that could be (16) her in the future. She does not want a scandal to affect her chances of getting elected.

1 held against　**2** kept from　**3** grown into　**4** sailed through

(17) Debt adds up quickly, so people with credit cards must be careful not to (17) large bills before checking how much they have spent.

1 phase out　**2** swear by　**3** rub in　**4** run up

(18) When the villagers heard a major typhoon was coming, they (18) preparing for the storm. They knew they had to hurry for their own safety.

1 set about　**2** took after　**3** brought down　**4** called on

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q19-Q21

次の英文A，Bを読み，その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの( )に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

The Y2K Bug

From the mid-twentieth century, the use of computer systems increased rapidly, and many of them employed software that represented years with their final two digits. Some experts pointed out that the two-digit system (19). For example, there was the question of what would happen in the year 2000 if computer systems incorrectly interpreted the final two digits to mean 1900 instead of 2000. Regardless, such concerns were largely brushed aside; the two-digit system saved space and became standard. As the new millennium approached, however, concerns reemerged that this so-called Y2K bug might cause malfunctions in infrastructure, such as banking, power plants, and air traffic control.

In the 1990s, governments began to take the threat more seriously. Efforts centered around measures to deal with worst-case scenarios or focused on prevention by encouraging organizations in both public and private sectors to fix their computer codes. (20), the United States funded efforts by the World Bank to increase awareness of the Y2K bug in developing nations, and the British government put the armed forces on standby, ready to assist the emergency services.

On January 1, 2000, the more extreme predictions did not come to pass. Although some issues arose, they were generally relatively minor and easy to resolve. For supporters of Y2K-bug initiatives, the ongoing viability of major computer systems and essential services was seen as a success; disaster had been avoided. Some (21). They questioned whether the threat had ever been as dangerous as predicted, and they suggested that governments had wasted billions of dollars on unnecessary prevention measures.

(19)

1 was the only viable option　**2** might have limitations　**3** could only be understood by scientists　**4** mainly benefited large businesses

(20)

1 Furthermore　**2** However　**3** In any case　**4** On the contrary

(21)

1 governments wanted their money back　**2** problems could not be fixed　**3** new bugs were found　**4** people saw it differently

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q22-Q24

次の英文A，Bを読み，その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの( )に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Searching for a Sixth Taste

Scientists recognize five basic tastes: sweet, salty, sour, bitter, and umami. In 1908, the Japanese chemist Ikeda Kikunae identified umami as a distinct savory taste produced primarily by a chemical compound called glutamic acid. People had consumed foods rich in umami for centuries, including kombu, mushrooms, and fermented sauces. (22), scientific agreement on umami's status was difficult to reach. In fact, it took nearly a hundred years of debate and experimental research before umami was recognized worldwide as a distinct basic taste.

Determining whether a new taste qualifies as "basic" is a complex process. While there is no set of official criteria, scientists have proposed certain conditions that should be met. For one, the taste must be activated by distinct chemicals that are unrelated to other tastes. In addition, the taste (23). For example, when a person tastes something sweet, the chemical insulin is released into the bloodstream.

In recent years, several possible candidates for a sixth taste have been proposed, including starchy and fatty. Scientists are particularly interested in the fatty taste, as it has proved to be the strongest candidate so far. Fatty acids activate certain taste receptors that are located on the tongue, and the taste leads to measurable responses in the human body. Scientists point out that certain tastes (24). For example, studies link reduced sensitivity to the fatty taste with overeating and conditions like obesity. Understanding taste more fully may help explain dietary choices and health outcomes.

(22)

1 In exchange　**2** Consequently　**3** Nevertheless　**4** In short

(23)

1 should be found in a range of food sources　**2** must trigger a physical response in the body　**3** should be easy for people to describe　**4** must last for a certain amount of time

(24)

1 could lose their significance in the future　**2** remain constant throughout a person's lifetime　**3** often have cultural and historical significance　**4** influence eating behavior and health

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ25-Q27に答えなさい。

Employment Requirements for Welfare

Every month, millions of low-income Americans rely on the United States' Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) to afford basic groceries. SNAP recipients receive benefits loaded onto an electronic card, which can be used at authorized stores to purchase food items. Despite the program's long history of success, in the 1990s, concerns that reliance on SNAP would decrease people's motivation to better themselves economically caused policymakers to introduce stricter employment requirements for certain SNAP participants. In particular, the reforms targeted able-bodied adults without dependents, such as single people living alone. It was hoped that the changes would motivate such individuals to seek employment and discourage long-term reliance on public support. Multiple studies that have examined the validity of these reforms, though, have indicated that the reforms had little or no effect on their overall employment rate.

Opponents of the employment requirements also point out that while the policy is meant to apply to what are known as able-bodied adults without dependents, in practice, that category includes a wide range of people with varying levels of health, ability to work, and responsibility for others. For instance, individuals recovering from surgery, managing mental illness, or facing housing instability may be classified as "able-bodied" despite significant barriers to regular employment. Moreover, many low-wage jobs provide unpredictable or limited working hours, so people can find themselves falling below the required minimums through no fault of their own. This inconsistency between rigid policy definitions and real-world conditions often leads to the loss of food assistance among people who are actively trying to support themselves.

Research has also demonstrated that when recessions occur and unemployment rises, the demand for food assistance increases. However, SNAP work requirements do not always adjust quickly or automatically to these changing conditions. This creates a situation where people who have recently become unemployed may suddenly lose eligibility for assistance because they no longer meet the minimum work hours. This also has broader consequences beyond individual hardship. SNAP benefits are typically spent immediately and within one's own community, helping to sustain demand in the economy. Without it, struggling areas lose not only food support but also a source of economic activity that could lessen the impact of job losses. By restricting access to SNAP benefits during economic downturns, the program loses its ability to protect both families and communities from deeper economic harm. Taken together, the flaws in efforts to enforce employment requirements for SNAP reveal a policy approach that some experts believe ignores both human needs and economic realities.

大問3A 長文設問 Q25-Q27

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(25) According to the first paragraph, studies of the effects of reforms to SNAP have shown that

1 the changes seem to have had much more effect on people with dependents than on those who did not have them.

2 people who were removed from SNAP frequently returned to the program later with stronger motivation to remain employed.

3 although the changes were intended to encourage people to find jobs, they were mostly unsuccessful in doing so.

4 providing benefits through electronic cards rather than cash payments significantly increased recipients' willingness to search for stable employment.

(26) What do we learn about how employment requirements for SNAP can affect able-bodied adults without dependents?

1 Rules often disqualify individuals who face barriers to employment that are real but may not be covered by official policies.

2 They allow people with irregular job schedules to receive payments as long as they work fewer hours than a full-time job.

3 The longer a person has been receiving SNAP benefits, the more likely they are to be affected by the changes.

4 People who are classified as able-bodied typically lose the opportunity to do part-time work.

(27) What has research shown about the wider economic effects of employment requirements for SNAP benefits?

1 They are much more effective for reducing unemployment rates when a recession is not as serious.

2 Evidence suggests that they tend to encourage recipients to relocate to areas where more jobs are available.

3 They tend to free up resources for other types of government programs that promote economic recovery.

4 Because SNAP benefits have the effect of stimulating local economies, enforcing work requirements can make it harder to recover from recessions.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ28-Q31に答えなさい。

Saint Helena

A navigator aboard a Portuguese vessel returning from India is credited with discovering the South Atlantic island of Saint Helena in 1502. Although it was uninhabited, the Portuguese did not establish a permanent settlement there. Instead, with abundant forests and resources, the island became a staging post for their ships to restock with water and other provisions. For approximately eighty years, this isolated island remained a secret, known only to the Portuguese. However, after English explorer Thomas Cavendish came across the island, that changed. Although the Dutch also attempted to control this strategically important island in the seventeenth century, it was an English trading company, the East India Company, that ultimately took possession of it.

As more settlers arrived, infrastructure was developed, and the island became an important hub for the company's vessels. During its growth period, enslaved people were brought to the island to work on plantations. However, after Britain outlawed the slave trade in 1807, the British navy used the island as a base from which to intercept ships carrying slaves. Although the island remained a key port until well into the nineteenth century, it began to experience a decline. The introduction of steamships was a factor, as these vessels could travel longer distances than sailing ships without resupplying. It has also been argued that the Suez Canal, which opened in 1869 and provided a shorter route between Europe and Asia, had an impact.

The British also utilized Saint Helena for another purpose. After Napoleon I, emperor of the French, was defeated at the Battle of Waterloo in 1815, he was captured. The year before, Napoleon had given up his title and been exiled to Elba, a Mediterranean island. However, he later escaped, returned to France, and regained power. This time, the British were determined to take no chances, and Saint Helena seemed the perfect choice. The island's isolated location would make it extremely difficult for any rescue mission to land without being spotted. The British even stationed some soldiers on Ascension Island over one thousand kilometers away to prevent its use as a base for any French rescue attempt. Not held in a standard prison, Napoleon mainly resided at a secure residence called Longwood House, where he was kept under constant surveillance until he died in 1821.

From a geographic perspective, the volcanic island's isolation also contributed to the evolution of unique native animal and plant species over millions of years. Its physical geography is varied, with steep cliffs and forested interior highlands. Since the discovery of the island, however, its environment has been undermined. The introduction of invasive species and livestock, and resource exploitation through deforestation, have taken their toll, leading to the formation of semidesert areas. Nevertheless, community initiatives have been established to turn the tide on this habitat loss by replanting native trees. Although some native species are already extinct, there is optimism that recreating the forests that existed before colonization can secure the future of surviving native species.

大問3B 長文設問 Q28-Q31

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(28) What is one thing that happened after Saint Helena was discovered in 1502?

1 Although there was evidence that vessels of other European nations had already visited, the Portuguese claimed the island for Portugal.

2 The Portuguese realized that they could profit from the island's wealth of natural resources by charging Dutch and other nations' vessels to restock there.

3 The East India Company quickly took control of the island before it was found by anyone else, allowing it to exploit the natural resources there.

4 The Portuguese were able to take advantage of the island's natural resources for decades because other nations were not aware of its existence.

(29) What is one point the author of the passage makes about the use of Saint Helena as a port in the nineteenth century?

1 Its use declined around 1807 because the British navy no longer needed it to patrol the South Atlantic in its fight against the slave trade.

2 A technological development in the shipping industry contributed to the decline of its utility as a resupply port for trade ships.

3 Even after 1807, some ships carrying slaves demanded the use of Saint Helena's port facilities before continuing their journeys across the South Atlantic.

4 Many nations continued to use it even after the Suez Canal opened because they had established facilities there that enabled them to resupply quickly.

(30) What do we learn about the British regarding their treatment of Napoleon I?

1 They took as many precautions as they felt necessary to ensure that there could not be a repetition of the event that had occurred on Elba.

2 They should have considered relocating him to Ascension, as that island had more secure facilities than those on Saint Helena.

3 They would have preferred to hold him on the island of Elba because its proximity to Europe made it easier to keep British troops there.

4 They felt that he should have been kept in a regular prison, but there were no suitable facilities available on Saint Helena at that time.

(31) Regarding Saint Helena's environment, the author of the passage concludes that

1 it would be better for local environmental initiatives to focus on removing invasive species that have caused damage rather than spending money on replanting efforts.

2 efforts by Saint Helena islanders to restore forests damaged by centuries of exploitation could contribute to improvements in the island's natural environment.

3 the interior highlands have likely been able to avoid the environmental damage that other areas have suffered from due to their inaccessibility.

4 the local community should consider introducing animal species from other South Atlantic islands that are similar to those that have become extinct on Saint Helena.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。

Q01-Q11	
Q01	**1**
restrain	
Q02	**4**
bare	
Q03	**4**
itinerary	
Q04	**3**
familiarize	
Q05	**3**
urgency	
Q06	**4**
ornaments	
Q07	**2**
clerical	
Q08	**1**
loiter	
Q09	**1**
preoccupied	
Q10	**4**
inspection	
Q11	**4**
idealistic	

Q12-Q21	
Q12	**1**
peculiar	
Q13	**4**
prominence	
Q14	**2**
excerpt	
Q15	**1**
hammer out	
Q16	**1**
held against	
Q17	**4**
run up	
Q18	**1**
set about	
Q19	**2**
might have limitations	
Q20	**1**
Furthermore	
Q21	**4**
people saw it differently	

Q22-Q31	
Q22	**3**
Nevertheless	
Q23	**2**
must trigger a physical response in the body	
Q24	**4**
influence eating behavior and health	
Q25	**3**
Q26	**1**
Q27	**4**
Q28	**4**
Q29	**2**
Q30	**1**
Q31	**2**

学習記録　得点 ＿＿＿＿ / 31　やり直す問題 ＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

メモ ＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿